Targeting Scar States Using Polynomial Filtering in the PXP Hamiltonian

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Eigenstate Thermalization Hypothesis (ETH)

- Explains thermalization in isolated quantum many-body systems.
- Local observables relax to match expected values from statistical mechanics.
- Individual generic eigenstates mimic thermal ensembles.

Important: ETH Violations

Some systems have rare, unusual eigenstates that strongly violate ETH and fail to thermalize.

The PXP Model & Quantum Many-Body Scars

- Models projected spin-flip dynamics on a 1D Rydberg atom chain:

$$H = \sum_{i=0}^{L-1} P_i X_{(i+1)\%L} P_{(i+2)\%L} \tag{1}$$

  where $P_i = \frac{1}{2}(\mathbb{I} - Z_i)$ projects site i onto its ground state $|0\rangle$.
- ETH-violating eigenstates form **quantum many-body scar states**.
- Scars are rare, evenly spaced, and possess unusually low entanglement.
- But there is the usual problem, the Hilbert space grows exponentially.

Problem of the Project

Can we use Chebyshev polynomial filtering to target the scar states without doing full exact diagonalization?

Understanding the PXP Hamiltonian

- The Rydberg blockade excludes configurations with adjacent excitations, such as $|\cdots 11 \cdots\rangle$.
- Basis states are represented as nodes in an adjacency graph.
- The physical blockade-constrained subspace appears as the largest connected component of this graph.

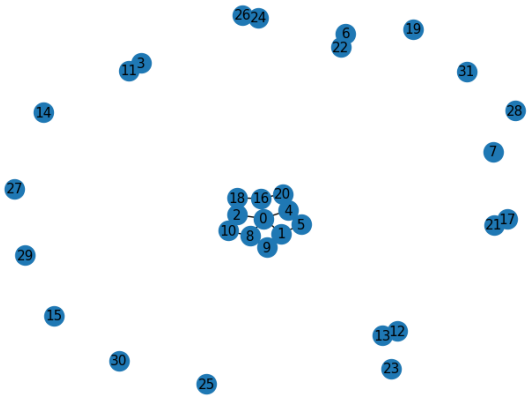


Figure: Full computational basis adjacency graph for an $L = 5$ chain.

PXP Hamiltonian is Sparse

$$H = \begin{pmatrix}
\cdot & 1 & 1 & \cdot & 1 & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & 1 & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot \\
1 & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & 1 & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot \\
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\cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot & \cdot
\end{pmatrix} \tag{2}$$

The Constrained Dimension Grows as a Fibonacci Sequence

For open boundary conditions, the blockade constraint gives the recursion

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(L+1) = \mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(L) + \mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(L-1). \tag{3}$$

The two terms correspond to adding $|0\rangle$ freely, or adding $|1\rangle$ after a forced neighboring $|0\rangle$. With $\mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(1) = 2$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(2) = 3$,

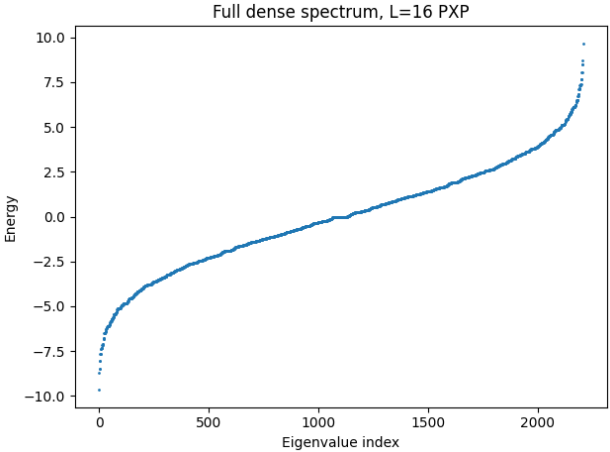
$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{open}}(L) \sim \phi^L, \qquad \phi = \frac{1+\sqrt{5}}{2}. \tag{4}$$

For periodic boundary conditions, the first and last sites are also constrained:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{periodic}}(L) = F_{L+1} + F_{L-1}. \tag{5}$$

Reference Benchmark via Full Exact Diagonalization

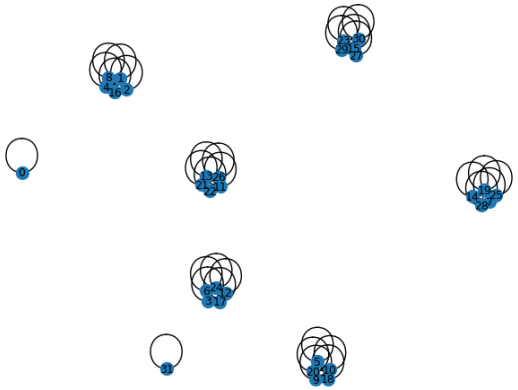
- Dense solvers (`scipy.linalg.eigh`) compute the full spectrum.
- For system size $L = 16$, the constrained sector dimension is $\mathcal{D} = 2207$.
- This exact spectrum will be our benchmark for later numerical methods.



Translation Symmetry Momentum Splitting

- Periodic chains commute with translation: $[H, T] = 0$.
- We decompose space into momentum blocks $k = 2\pi n_k / L$.
- Symmetrized basis states built from orbit families $\mathcal{F}(\vec{n})$:

$$|\psi_{k,\vec{n}}\rangle = \frac{1}{\mathcal{N}_{k,\vec{n}}} \sum_{r=1}^{L} e^{ikr}\, T^r\, |\mathrm{rep}(\vec{n})\rangle\,. \tag{6}$$



Orbit Selection Rules & Momentum Sector Diagonalization

When we look at the normalization for $f_{\vec{n}} < L$, the normalization condition gives us

$$f_{\vec{n}} n_k \pmod{L} = 0. \tag{7}$$

If this rule is not satisfied, then the projected momentum state must be omitted from the basis.
For normalizable states,

$$|\psi_{k,\vec{n}}\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{f_{\vec{n}}}} \sum_{r=1}^{f_{\vec{n}}} e^{ikr} T^r \, |\mathrm{rep}(\vec{n})\rangle \, . \tag{8}$$

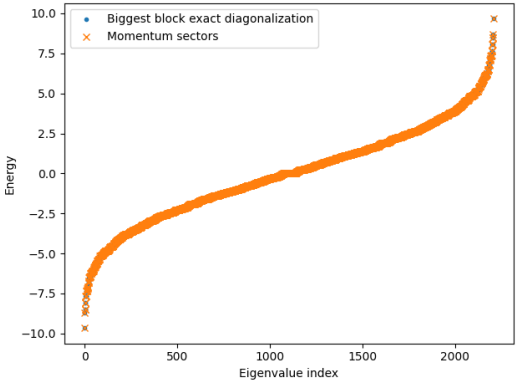


Figure: Exact energy eigenvalues resolved across isolated momentum sectors.